

EXPLORATION OF ZOHIO CREATOR PLATFORM

Name: Raghavi S

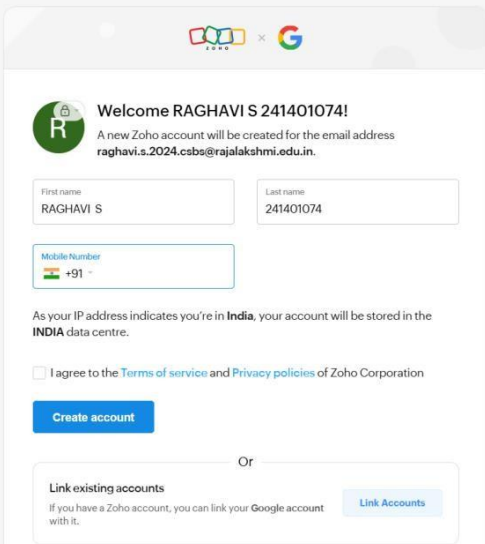
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1. Introduction

Zoho Creator is a cloud-based low-code application development platform that enables users to build custom web and mobile applications with minimal programming knowledge. It provides an intuitive drag-and-drop interface, built-in automation features, database management, reporting tools, and workflow integration. The purpose of this exploration was to understand the overall interface of Zoho Creator, examine its major modules, and learn how each component contributes to the application development process.

2. Account Creation

The exploration began by creating a Zoho Creator account using the college Google account. During registration, the platform requested basic information such as the user's name, email address, and mobile number. After agreeing to the terms and conditions, the account was successfully created, and access to the Zoho Creator dashboard was granted. The account was activated under a 15-day trial plan, allowing access to most of the platform's core features.

A screenshot of the Zoho Creator account creation interface. At the top, there are logos for Zoho and Google. Below them, a green circular profile icon with the letter 'R' is shown next to the text "Welcome RAGHAVI S 241401074!". A message states: "A new Zoho account will be created for the email address raghavi.s.2024.cbs@rajalakshmi.edu.in." The form contains three input fields: "First name" with the value "RAGHAVI S", "Last name" with the value "241401074", and "Mobile Number" with a dropdown for the country code set to "+91". Below these fields, a message says: "As your IP address indicates you're in India, your account will be stored in the INDIA data centre." There is a checkbox labeled "I agree to the Terms of service and Privacy policies of Zoho Corporation" which is currently unchecked. A blue "Create account" button is positioned below the checkbox. Underneath, the text "Or" is centered. Below "Or", there is a section titled "Link existing accounts" with the subtext "If you have a Zoho account, you can link your Google account with it." and a blue "Link Accounts" button.

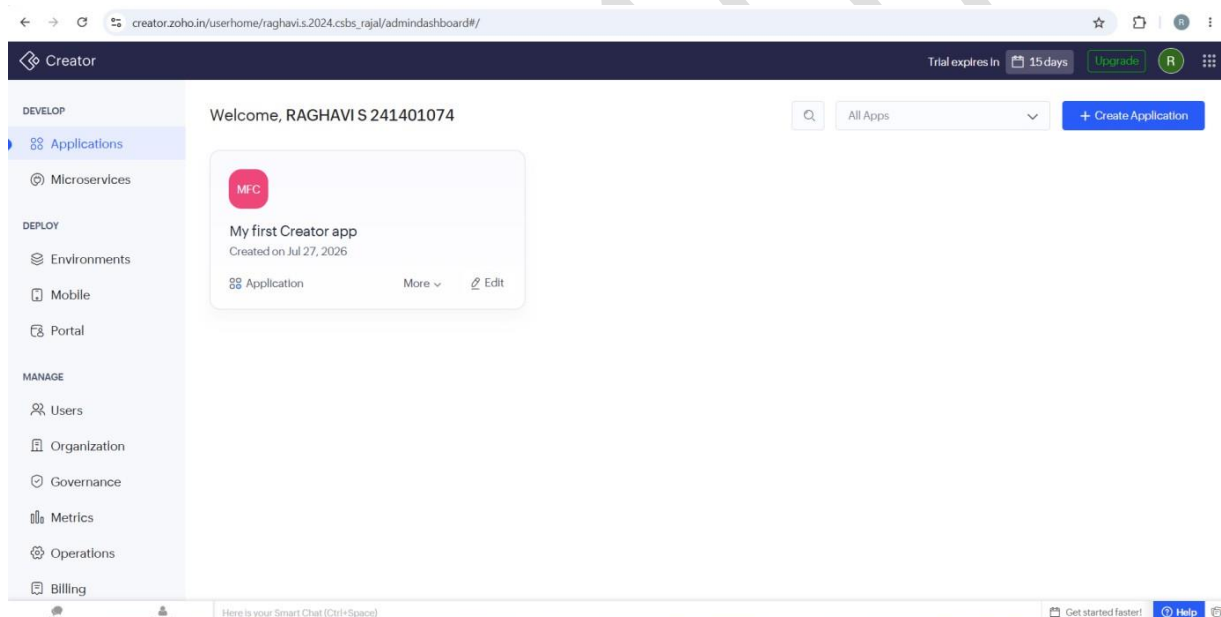
3. Dashboard Overview

After logging in, the Zoho Creator dashboard served as the central workspace for managing applications and administrative settings. The dashboard displayed the user's profile, the remaining trial period, and a navigation menu

containing various development and management modules. A default application named "**My First Creator App**" was already available, giving a starting point for understanding the application's structure. The dashboard layout was clean and organised, making navigation straightforward even for beginners.

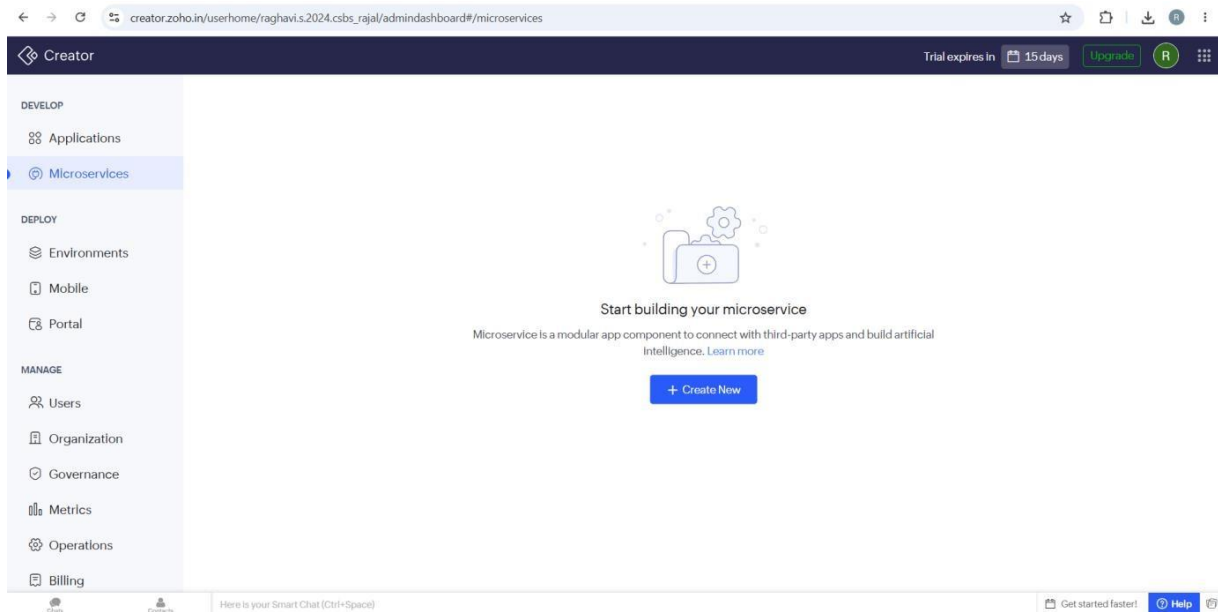
4. Applications Module

The **Applications** module is the primary workspace where all applications are created and managed. It allows users to create new applications, edit existing ones, and organise projects in a single location. During the exploration, the default application was visible along with options to edit or access additional settings. This module demonstrates how Zoho Creator simplifies application development by providing an organised environment for managing multiple projects.



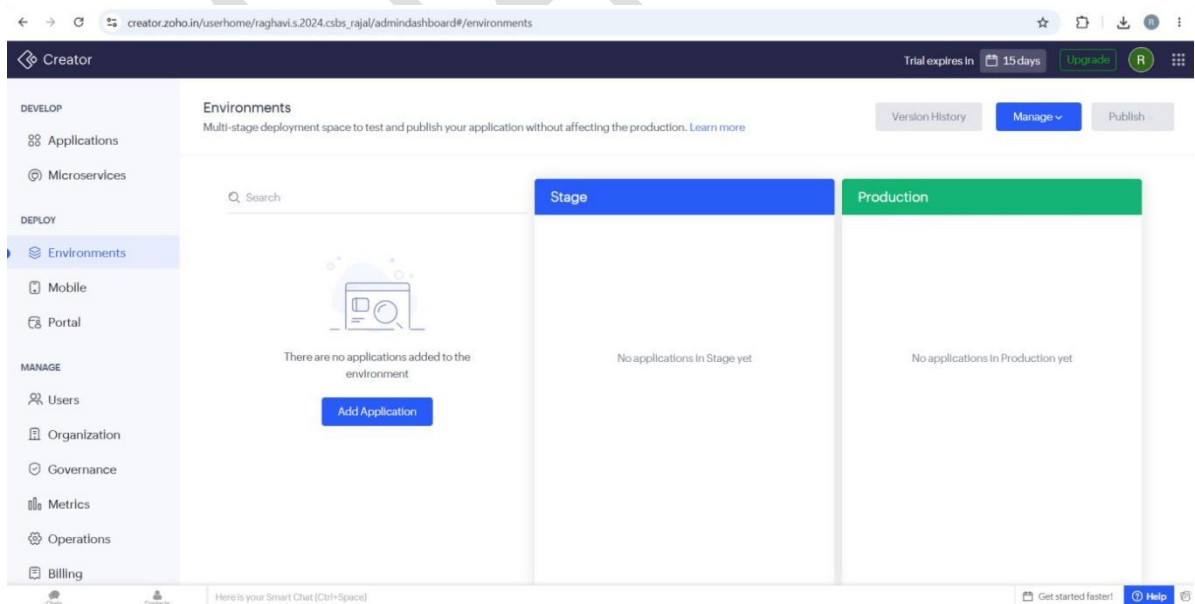
5. Microservices Module

The **Microservices** section is designed for building modular services that can communicate with external applications through APIs. Although no microservices were created during the exploration, the interface clearly indicated that this feature supports integration with third-party systems and artificial intelligence services. This functionality is particularly useful for organisations that need scalable and reusable services within larger software ecosystems.



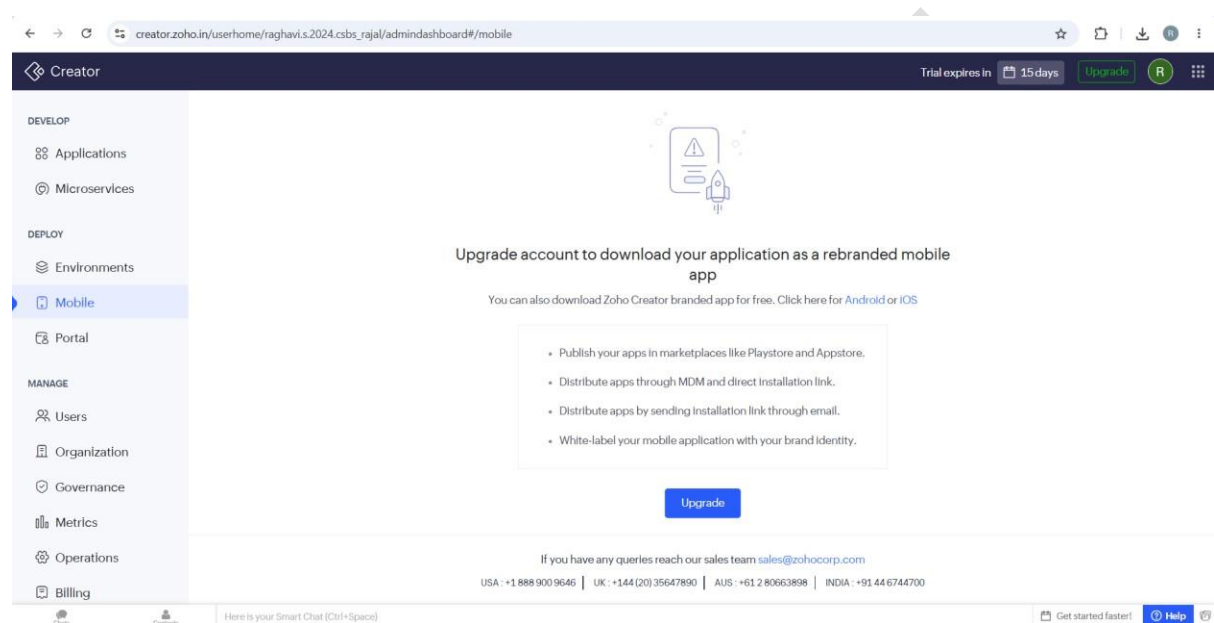
6. Environments Module

The **Environments** module introduces a multi-stage deployment process consisting of Development, Stage, and Production environments. This structure enables developers to build and test applications before making them available to end users. At the time of exploration, no applications had been deployed, but the interface demonstrated how Zoho Creator separates testing from production, helping to reduce deployment risks and improve software quality.



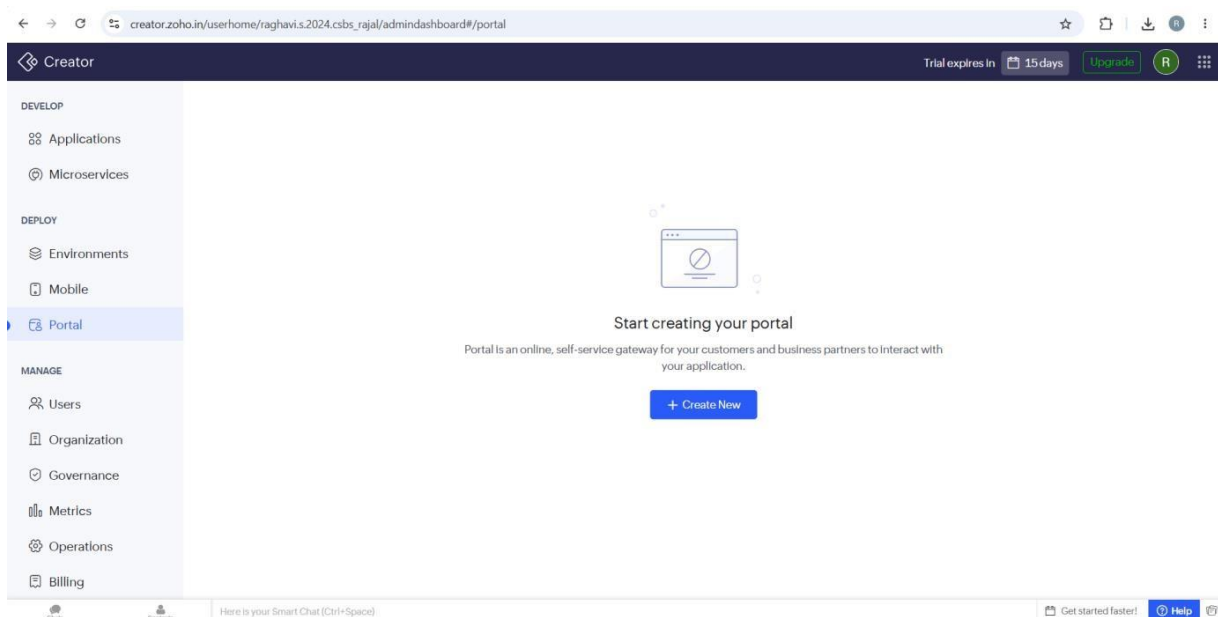
7. Mobile Module

The **Mobile** section highlights Zoho Creator's capability to generate mobile applications from web-based projects. The exploration showed that advanced mobile deployment features, including Android and iOS publishing, white-label branding, and application distribution, are available after upgrading the subscription. This demonstrates Zoho Creator's ability to support cross-platform application development from a single project.



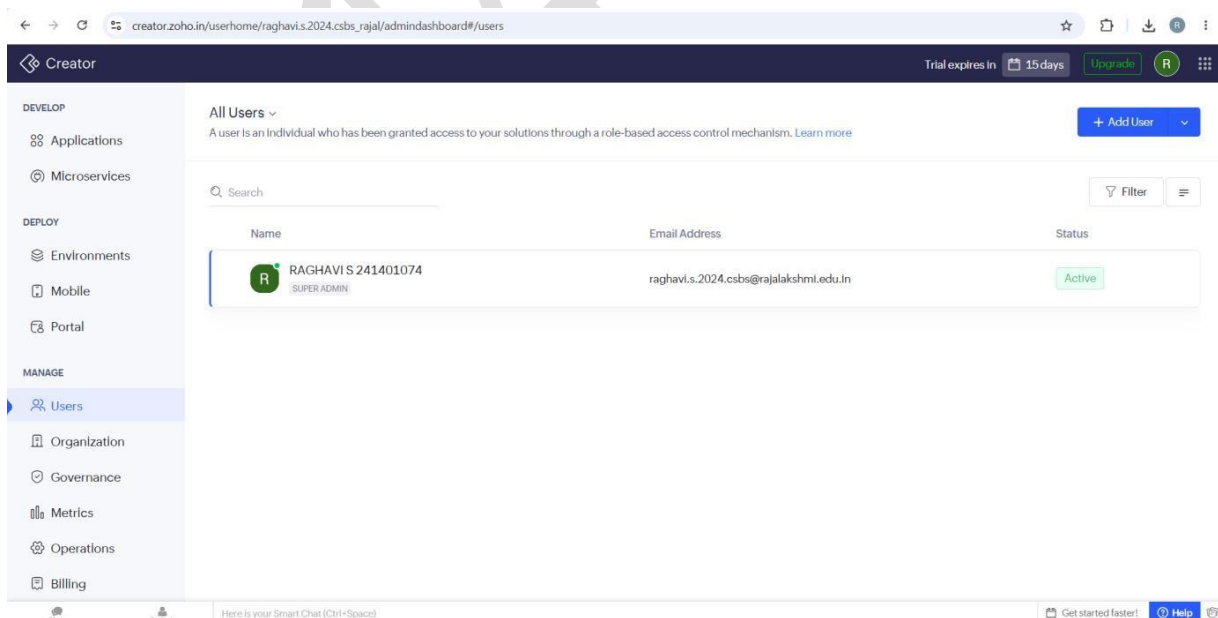
8. Portal Module

The **Portal** module enables organisations to create secure web portals for customers, employees, or business partners. These portals allow external users to access selected parts of an application based on their permissions. Although no portal was created during the exploration, the interface provided a clear understanding of how businesses can extend application access beyond internal users while maintaining security.



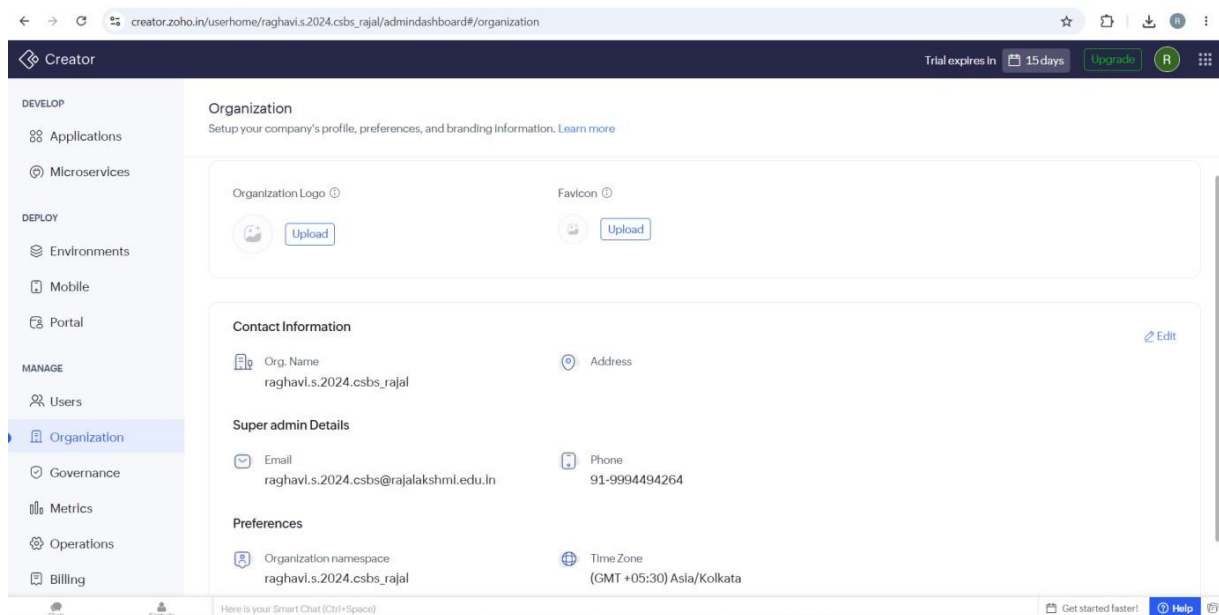
9. Users Module

The **Users** section manages everyone who has access to the applications. During the exploration, the registered account appeared as the Super Administrator with active status. The module also included an option to add additional users and assign different access levels. This demonstrates Zoho Creator's support for role-based access control, which is essential for collaborative application development.



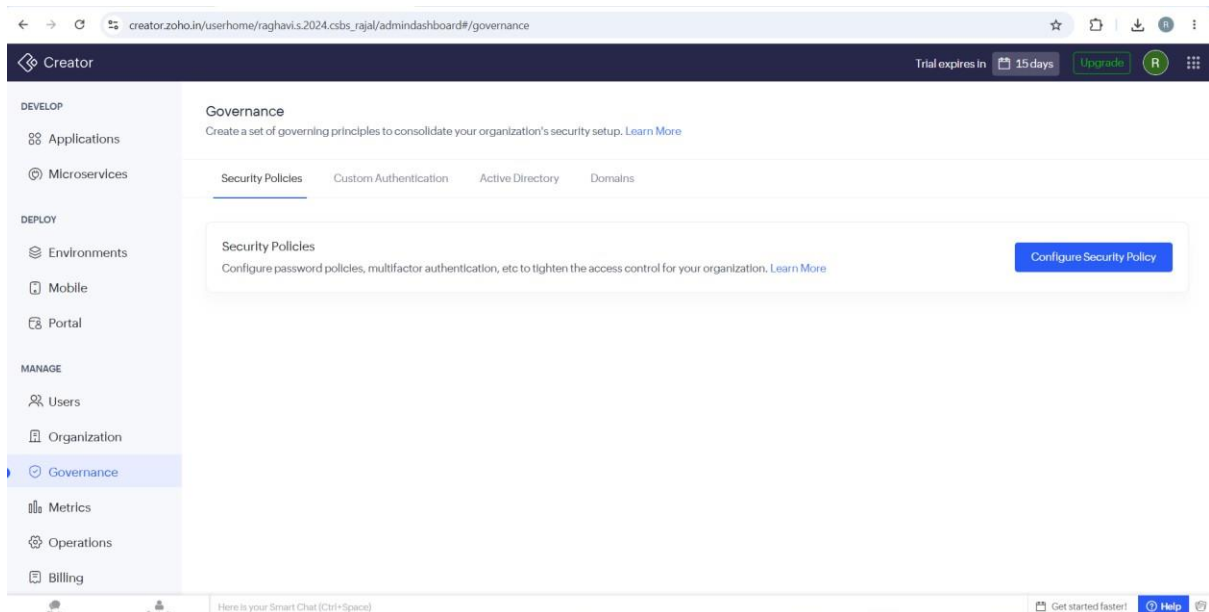
10. Organization Module

The **Organization** module contains administrative settings related to company information and branding. It provides options to upload an organisation logo and favicon while also displaying contact details, administrator information, and regional settings such as the time zone. These settings help personalise applications and ensure consistency across all organisational projects.



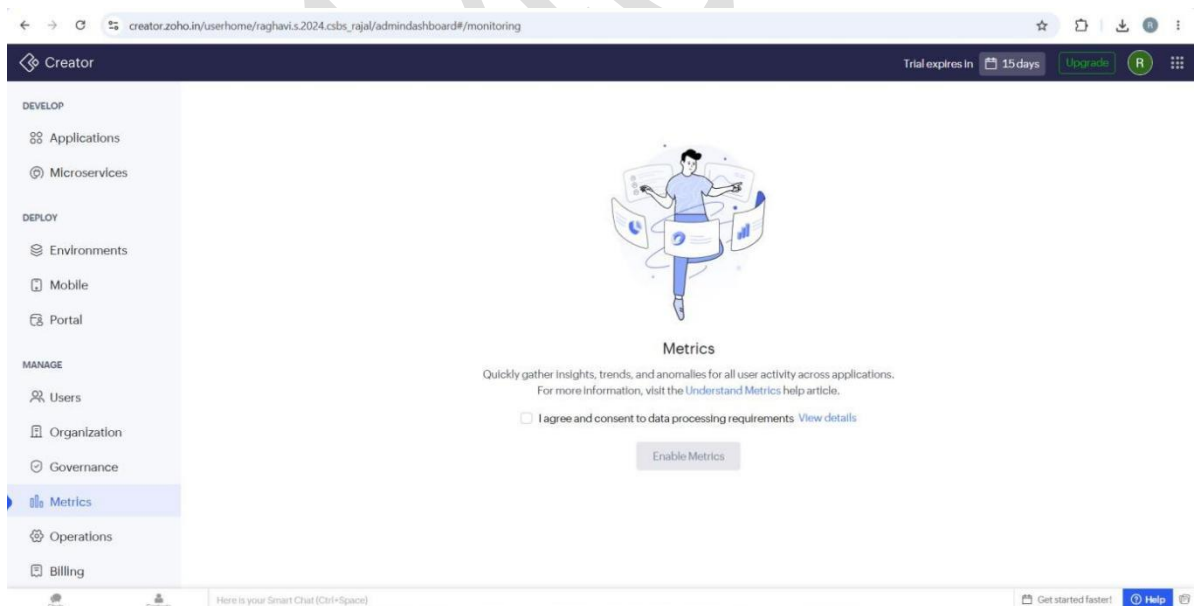
11. Governance Module

The **Governance** section focuses on application security and user authentication. It includes features for configuring password policies, multi-factor authentication, custom authentication methods, Active Directory integration, and domain management. Although no security policies were configured during the exploration, this module highlights Zoho Creator's emphasis on maintaining secure application environments.



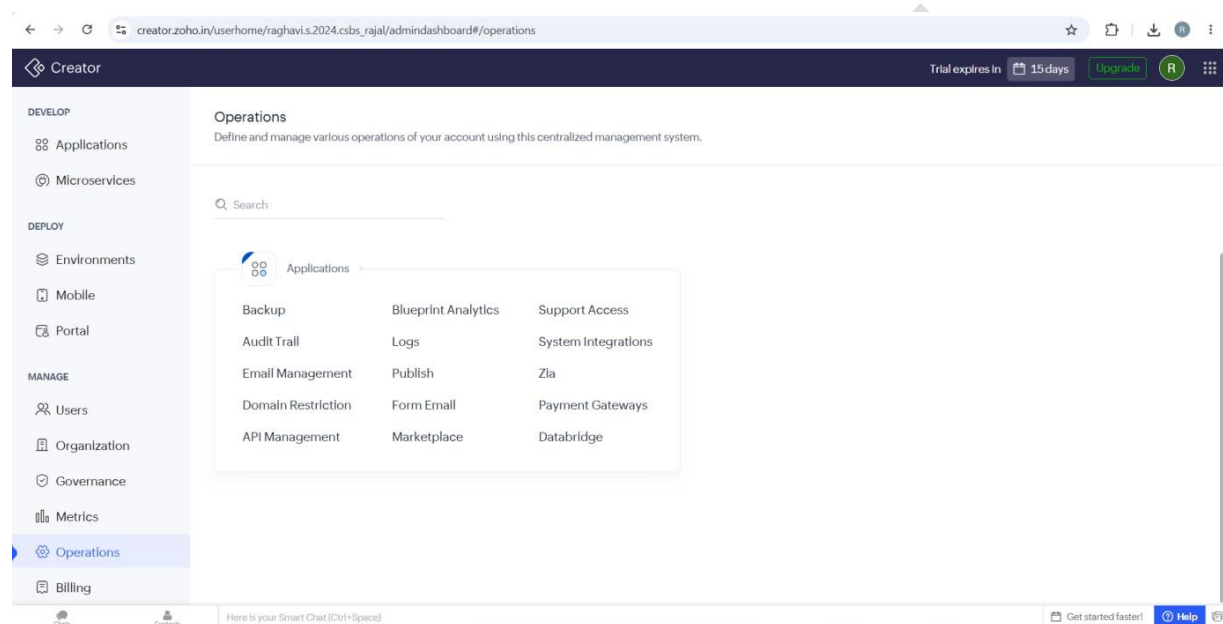
12. Metrics Module

The **Metrics** module provides analytical insights into application performance and user activity. It is intended to help administrators monitor trends, identify anomalies, and evaluate overall system usage. During the exploration, the feature required user consent before activation, indicating Zoho Creator's commitment to responsible data collection and privacy.



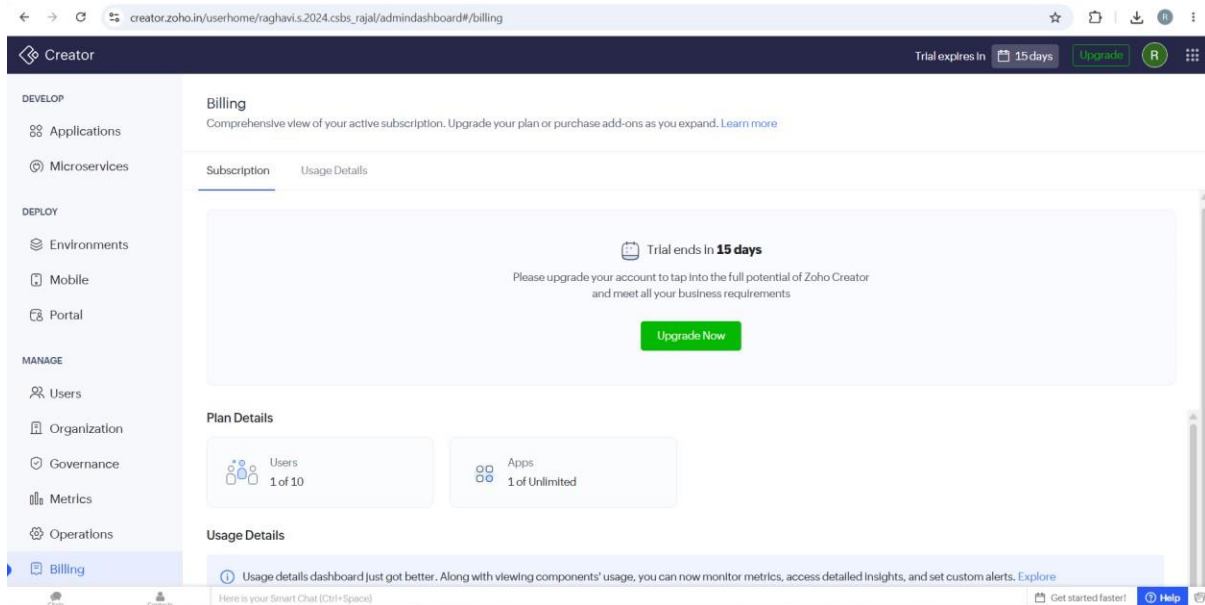
13. Operations Module

The **Operations** module acts as a central management hub for maintaining applications after development. It includes features such as backups, audit trails, logs, email management, API management, marketplace integrations, payment gateways, publishing tools, and support access. These operational features help developers manage applications efficiently throughout their lifecycle.



14. Billing Module

The **Billing** section provides information about the current subscription, trial period, usage statistics, and available upgrade options. The exploration revealed that the account was operating under a 15-day free trial with one active user. This section helps users monitor their subscription status and understand the available plans as application requirements grow.



15. Overall Learning

This exploration provided a comprehensive understanding of Zoho Creator's interface and its major components. The platform combines application development, deployment, security, user management, analytics, and administration within a single cloud-based environment. Even without building a complete application, exploring the dashboard offered valuable insight into how business applications can be developed, managed, and maintained using a low-code approach.

Advantages

- **Easy to Use:** Zoho Creator has a simple and user-friendly interface, making it easy for beginners to create applications with minimal coding knowledge.
- **Rapid Application Development:** The low-code platform enables users to quickly design, build, and deploy business applications.
- **Workflow Automation:** It provides built-in automation features that help streamline business processes and reduce manual work.
- **Cloud and Mobile Support:** Applications can be accessed through the cloud and are compatible with both web and mobile platforms.
- **Secure and Scalable:** Zoho Creator offers role-based access control and can be used by both small businesses and large organisations, making it a flexible and secure solution.

Limitations

- **Paid Features:** Some advanced features, such as white-labelled mobile applications and certain deployment options, are only available with a paid subscription.
- **Limited Trial Period:** The free trial is available only for a limited duration, restricting long-term exploration without upgrading.
- **Additional Configuration Required:** Certain modules, such as **Metrics**, require user consent or additional configuration before they can be used.
- **Upgrade Required for Full Functionality:** Several advanced capabilities are locked behind premium plans, limiting access in the trial version.
- **Feature Restrictions:** Trial users cannot access all enterprise-level features, which may limit testing of the platform's complete capabilities.

Conclusion

The exploration of Zoho Creator demonstrated that it is a powerful low-code development platform capable of supporting the complete application lifecycle, from development to deployment and maintenance. Its well-organised interface, comprehensive administrative tools, and cloud-based architecture make it an effective solution for rapidly developing business applications. Overall, the exploration provided a strong understanding of the platform's capabilities and established a solid foundation for future application development using Zoho Creator.